
Care Guide No.3 Caring For Your Retainers

You have finished the active part of your treatment and it's time to make sure that the result we have achieved stays as it is.

- If you are having a permanent retainer fitted wear your plastic retainer full time until the permanent retainer is placed. Once the permanent retainer is fitted wear the plastic retainer at night only.
- If you are not having a permanent retainer fitted then you should wear your retainers every night, without exception. Avoid taking advice from friends, family members, or the internet.
- If you stop wearing your retainers, your teeth will move!

Only Remove Retainers For

- Eating, drinking, or cleaning your teeth
- Swimming or sport where you are wearing a mouth guard.
- When your retainers are out of your mouth they must be kept in a box. Never wrap them in a tissue or leave them lying about. Keep them out of reach of pets.
- The safest place for your retainers is in your mouth!

Cleaning Retainers

- Only clean your retainer by placing in a cup of cold water. Add half a tablet of Steradent or Retainer Brite and leave for at least 5 minutes.
- Make sure the water is cold to avoid distorting the retainer shape.
- Clean as above every morning, making up a new solution every morning.
- Do not use a toothbrush or toothpaste on your retainers. Using a brush may cause the retainer to flex and over time it will split in half. Using paste will scratch your retainer and it will become cloudy in time.

Supervision of Retention

- We will supervise your retainers for one year after treatment. During this time we will ask you to return periodically to check that you are wearing your retainers as instructed.
- Please bring your retainers with you for every appointment.

Lost Retainers

- You must contact the practice immediately if you lose your retainers. Failure to do so, will result in your teeth moving. The National Health Service will not pay to straighten your teeth again.
- Even though you may be under the age of 18, if you lose your retainers, you will have to pay for them. The only exception to this, is if your family receives benefits. Proof of this must be given to the Practice in advance.
- Retainers cost £75.00 each.